

Figure D.4 Flash applications have native support for cross-origin requests.

on the server. This XML file is named crossdomain.xml, and it specifies rules such as which origins are allowed to make cross-origin requests, and which headers are allowed. The following code shows an example of the crossdomain.xml file from the Flickr API server.

```
<cross-domain-policy>
<allow-access-from domain="*" secure="false"/>
<allow-http-request-headers-from domain="*" headers="Authorization"/>
<site-control permitted-cross-domain-policies="master-only"/>
</cross-domain-policy>
```

The file in the preceding code indicates that any origin can make cross-origin requests (`domain="*"`), regardless of whether or not the origin supports SSL (`secure="false"`). The Authorization request header is allowed (`headers="Authorization"`) from all origins (`domain="*"`). A full specification of crossdomain.xml is available at www.adobe.com/devnet/articles/crossdomain_policy_file_spec.html.

Figure D.5 shows the flow of a cross-origin request from Flash. Before issuing a cross-origin request, Flash first reads the crossdomain.xml file ❶. If the policy maps to the client issuing the request, Flash sends the request to the server ❷.

Flash works best in cases where you need rich HTTP support, but you also need deep browser support. Like JSONP, Flash has been around for a long time, and it enjoys wide support across desktop browsers. It's more powerful than JSONP because

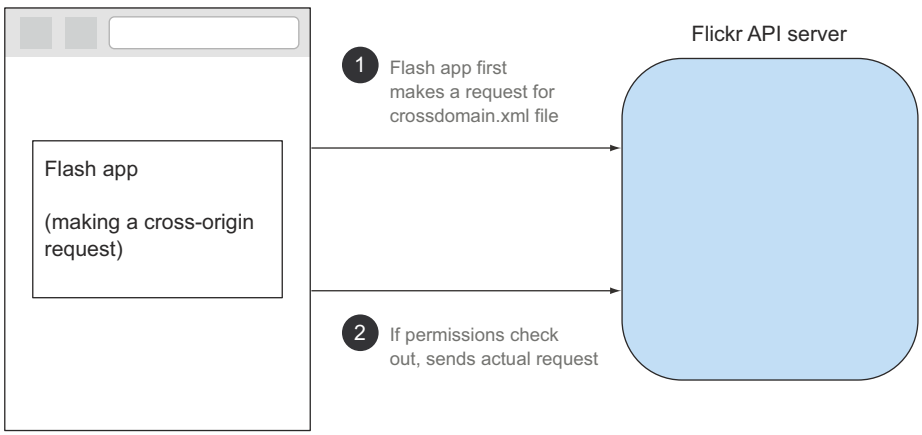


Figure D.5 Making a cross-origin request using Flash